

DishNet Secure Connect

Customer Setup Guide · version 1.1 · 2026-10-02

DishNet Secure Connect — Customer Setup Guide

Version 1.1 · 2026-10-02 · Support: WhatsApp 0705 993 348

1. Using Tally from anywhere — what the service does and does not do

This guide is about one thing: **doing your Tally accounting from another location**. Tally and your company data stay on your office computer. **DishNet Secure Connect** gives your laptop a private, encrypted connection to that computer, and **Windows Remote Desktop** shows you its screen so you work in Tally exactly as at your desk.

The four steps, every time:

1. **Tally stays at the office.** The office computer runs Tally and keeps the data. It stays on, online and set up for remote access.
2. **Connect DishNet Secure Connect.** Open the app and click *Connect to Office*.
3. **Open Remote Desktop.** Connect to the office computer and sign in with your own Windows account.
4. **Use Tally as usual.** Tally appears on the remote screen. Nothing is copied to your laptop.

It does	It does not
Connect your laptop to your office securely, from anywhere with internet	Copy Tally or your company data to your laptop
Let only computers authorised for <i>your</i> business use the connection	Let other DishNet customers see your office
Keep working across internet drops — it reconnects by itself	Show Tally by itself — Remote Desktop does that
Update itself when DishNet publishes a new version	Replace Tally, change Tally, or need any Tally setting

The one idea to remember: the connection links the computers; Remote Desktop shows the office screen; Tally runs on the office computer.

2. How it fits together

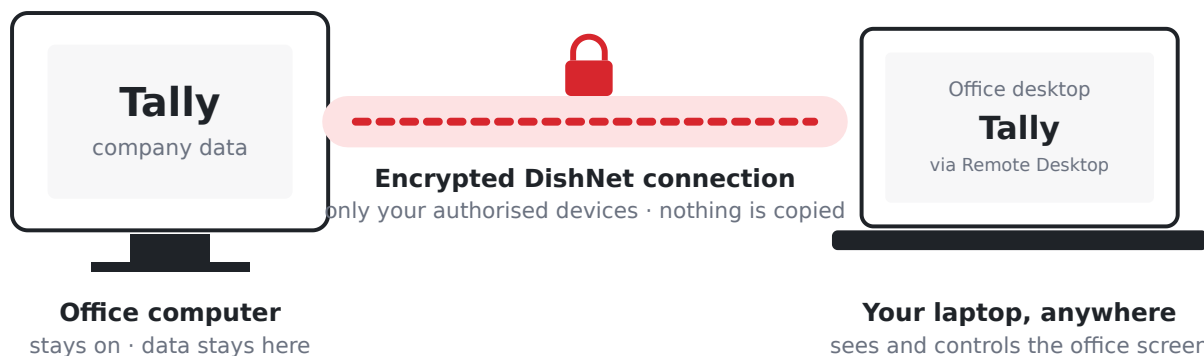


Diagram (not a screenshot): the connection links the computers; Remote Desktop shows the office screen; Tally runs on the office computer.

1. **Office computer** — keeps Tally and the data. Must stay on and online.
2. **DishNet** — the encrypted connection between your devices and the office. Only your authorised computers can use it.
3. **Your laptop** — sees and controls the office screen through Remote Desktop. Nothing is stored on it.

3. Before you start — requirements

Office computer (the one with Tally)

- Windows 10 or 11 **Pro**, or Windows Server. *Windows Home cannot accept Remote Desktop connections.* The recommended fix is to upgrade that computer to Windows Pro (a licence upgrade, no reinstall); otherwise use another office computer that runs Pro. DishNet can advise.
- Switched on and connected to the internet whenever staff need remote access. Turn off sleep/hibernate in Windows power settings.
- A Windows user account with a password for each person who will sign in remotely (Remote Desktop refuses accounts with no password).
- Tally already installed and working on this computer.

Each remote computer (staff laptops)

- Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit), any edition, with an administrator account to install the app once.

- Internet access (Starlink, mobile data, office Wi-Fi — any).
- The Windows user name and password of the office computer (kept by the staff member, never given to DishNet).

From DishNet

- An install link (or activation code) for the office computer, and one for your staff computers.
- The number of computers you are allowed is agreed with DishNet; each needs its own activation.

4. Setting up the office computer

1. On the office computer, open the **office install link** DishNet sent you. The file `DishNetSecureConnect-Setup-DN-....exe` downloads.
2. Run it. Windows shows "*Windows protected your PC*" — click **More info → Run anyway** (the pilot build is not yet code-signed). Click **Yes** when Windows asks for administrator permission; it is needed once to install the secure connection.
3. The app opens, activates by itself, and shows **Connected**.
4. The app then asks: "**Allow Remote Desktop for DishNet users?**" It explains exactly what it will change: switch on Windows Remote Desktop, and allow connections *only from DishNet-authorised devices* on the Remote Desktop port. Nothing is opened to the internet. Click **Allow** (the owner of the computer, or DishNet support with the owner present, makes this choice).
5. Leave the app running. It starts with Windows and reconnects by itself. The office computer is now reachable by your staff.

If you prefer to set Remote Desktop yourself instead of clicking Allow, use Windows Settings → System → Remote Desktop, and allow the DishNet connection range in Windows Firewall. DishNet support can walk you through it.

5. Installing and activating a staff computer

1. On the staff laptop, open the **staff install link**. Run the downloaded file (*More info → Run anyway*, then **Yes**).
2. The app opens with a short **2-minute tour** explaining the three steps. Watch it or choose *Watch later*; you can replay it any time with **How does this work?**
3. The app activates by itself (if you were given a code instead, type it and click **Activate**). Each code works once and registers only that computer.
4. The main screen shows your business name, this device, and **Your setup checklist**.

6. Connecting

1. Click **Connect to Office**. Within a few seconds the status reads **Connected**.
2. The checklist updates by itself: - ✓ Activation code accepted - ✓ Device registered - ✓ Secure connection to DishNet - **Office computer reachable** — the app tests whether the office computer answers. If it says *not answering*, the office computer is off, asleep, offline, or Remote Desktop was not allowed there yet.
3. **Next:** the line under the checklist always tells you what to do next.

7. Your first session — the guided practice run

Click **Set up Tally remote access** on the main screen. The app walks you through one complete session and marks each step: green ✓ when the software has checked it or you have confirmed it, ! when something needs attention.

Step	Who confirms it	What you do
1 This laptop is activated	software	Nothing — done by your install link
2 Connect to Office	software	Click <i>Connect to Office</i>
3 Office computer reachable	software	Wait a few seconds; the app tests the office computer
4 Open Remote Desktop	you	Click <i>Open Remote Desktop</i> , then <i>Connect</i> in the Windows window
5 Sign in	you	Type the office computer's Windows user name and password
6 Open Tally and select your company	you	The app names the company DishNet recorded for you
7 Do one simple task	you	For example view a report you are allowed to see
8 Finish properly	you	Close the company in Tally → close Remote Desktop → <i>Disconnect</i>

When all eight are done the app shows **Practice run complete**. From then on, daily use is: *Connect to Office* → *Open Remote Desktop* → *sign in* → *Tally*. You can repeat the practice run any time with **Practise again**.

If anything fails, click **Something is not working...** The troubleshooting assistant checks what it can see and asks at most three questions to tell you which layer is failing (activation, connection, office computer, Remote Desktop, Windows sign-in, or Tally) and who can fix it — see section 9.

8. Opening Remote Desktop and using Tally

1. Click **Open Remote Desktop**. Windows Remote Desktop opens with the office computer's address already filled in.
2. Click **Connect**, then sign in with the **Windows user name and password of the office computer**. If Windows warns that the computer's identity cannot be verified, choose *Yes* — you are connecting through DishNet's private connection, not the public internet.
3. The office desktop appears in a window (use the full-screen button at the top if it is small). Open Tally there exactly as you do at the office.
4. Back in the DishNet app, tick ✓ **Remote Desktop worked** and ✓ **Tally opened** so DishNet knows your setup is complete.

Only one person at a time can control a normal Windows PC through Remote Desktop. If a colleague is working on it, you will be asked whether to disconnect them — agree with them first.

9. Disconnecting

1. In Tally, save and close the company as usual.
2. Close the Remote Desktop window (or sign out inside it).
3. Click **Disconnect** in the DishNet app.

The office computer keeps running for others. You can leave the DishNet app open; it uses no data when idle.

10. When something does not work

Use **Something is not working...** in the app first. It works through six layers in order and stops at the first one that fails:

Layer	Typical sign	Who fixes it
1 Activation	"not activated", "access revoked", "trial has ended"	DishNet
2 DishNet connection	"Connecting..." or "Reconnecting..." that never ends	You — your laptop's internet
3 Office computer	"Office computer not answering"	The office — switch it on, check DishNet is Connected and <i>Allow</i> was clicked
4 Remote Desktop	Window does not open, or "the remote computer refused the connection"	You, then the office (Allow not clicked)
5 Windows sign-in	"The user name or password is incorrect"	Your office IT contact resets it; never DishNet
6 Tally	Tally opens but shows an error, licence or company problem	Your Tally provider

Or start at the top of this table and stop at the first line that matches what you see.

What you see	What it usually means	What to do
"Connecting..." for more than a minute	Your laptop has no internet	Open any website. Fix your internet first; the app connects by itself afterwards.
"Reconnecting..."	Your internet dropped	Wait. The app reconnects by itself when the internet is back.
"Office computer not answering"	Office PC off, asleep, offline, or Remote Desktop not allowed there	Ask someone at the office to switch it on and check the DishNet app there shows Connected and Remote Desktop was allowed.
Remote Desktop opens, sign-in fails	Wrong Windows user name/password of the office computer, or the account has no password	Use the office computer's own login. Set a password on that Windows account if it has none.
"Access revoked"	DishNet removed this device	Contact DishNet. A new install link/code is needed.
"Free trial has ended"	Your trial finished	Contact DishNet to continue; access returns within a minute of renewal.
"Problem" with a message	A local issue (permissions, tunnel component)	Close the app, right-click → Run as administrator. If it persists, click Save diagnostics... and send the file to DishNet.
Yellow bar "Version X is available"	An update is ready	Click Update now . No uninstall needed; activation stays.

Tally itself behaves exactly as it does at the office. Tally questions (licences, company files, errors inside Tally) are for your Tally provider; DishNet supports the connection and Remote Desktop.

11. Tally in your browser — no app needed (DishNet Web Desktop)

If DishNet has switched on **browser access** for your business, staff do not need the DishNet app or Remote Desktop at all:

1. Open **https://tally.dishnetuganda.com** in any browser (Windows, Mac, Chromebook, tablet).
2. Sign in with the login and password DishNet gave you. The first time, you choose your own password. This is *not* your Windows or Tally password.
3. Click **Open my office computer**. Type the **Windows** user name and password of the office computer (the same as at the office). DishNet does not store them.
4. The office desktop appears in the tab. Open Tally there as usual. When you finish: close the company in Tally, then click **Disconnect** at the top.

Recommended: on the **Security** page, switch on two-factor sign-in with an authenticator app on your phone. Lost the phone? Ask DishNet to switch it off for your login.

The office computer must still be on and online with the DishNet app showing Connected, exactly as for the app.

12. Several people at the same time

A standard Windows 10/11 Pro office computer lets **one person at a time** work through Remote Desktop. If a colleague is already working, Windows asks whether to disconnect them — agree with them first.

If your business needs several staff in Tally at the same time, that is not something the connection alone can provide. DishNet must assess, with you: Windows Server with Remote Desktop Services, its licensing (per user), and how your Tally is configured for multiple users. Ask DishNet before planning on it.

13. Security tips and support

- Never share your activation code or install link; each works once per computer.
- Never give your Windows or Tally password to anyone — DishNet will never ask for it.
- Lock your laptop when you step away; anyone using it could reach the office through the connection.
- Disconnect when you finish for the day.
- When a staff member leaves, tell DishNet; their device is removed within a minute.
- Keep the office computer updated and protected with antivirus, as for any business computer.
- Your data stays on your office computer. DishNet does not store, read or copy it; the connection is encrypted end to end (WireGuard®). Diagnostics files you send contain technical status only — secrets are removed automatically.

Contact DishNet support: WhatsApp 0705 993 348 Tell us your business name and what the app shows. Use **Save diagnostics...** in the app if we ask for the file.

Appendix — Help topics (as shown in the app)

What is DishNet Secure Connect?

DishNet Secure Connect is a small program that gives your computer a private, encrypted road to your office computer. It is not Tally and it does not show Tally by itself. Tally and your company data stay on the office computer, exactly as today.

Think of it in two parts: the **connection** (DishNet makes the private road) and **Remote Desktop** (the Windows tool that shows you the office screen so you can work on that computer from where you are).

How does it work?

1. **Your office computer** keeps Tally and the company data. It must stay switched on and connected to the internet, and DishNet must be set up on it as the "office computer".
2. **DishNet** connects your laptop to the office through an encrypted tunnel. Only devices that DishNet has authorised for your business can use it. Nobody else — not even other DishNet customers — can reach your office computer.
3. **Remote Desktop** shows you the office computer's screen. You sign in with your Windows user name and password for that computer, open Tally there, and work as if you were sitting in the office. Nothing is copied to your laptop.

Click **How does this work?** in the app any time to watch the short tour again.

Set up Tally remote access, step by step

The app has a guided workflow for exactly this: click **Set up Tally remote access** on the main screen. It walks you through one complete practice run and shows which steps the software has checked (green ✓) and which you confirm yourself.

1. **Activate this laptop** — happens by itself from your install link (or type your code once).
2. **Connect to Office** — opens the private connection. This does not open Tally yet.
3. **Office computer reachable** — the app tests that the office computer answers. If not, the office computer is off, offline, or Remote Desktop was not allowed there.
4. **Open Remote Desktop** — one click; Windows opens it with the office address filled in.
5. **Sign in** with the Windows user name and password you use on the office computer. DishNet never asks for it.
6. **Open Tally and select your company** — the app names the company DishNet recorded for you. Tally and the data stay on the office computer.

7. **Do one simple task** you are authorised to do (for example view a report), to prove it really works.
8. **Finish properly** — close the company in Tally, close the Remote Desktop window, then click Disconnect.

After the practice run, daily use is just: **Connect to Office → Open Remote Desktop → sign in → Tally**. You can practise again any time from the same screen.

How to connect for the first time

1. Install DishNet Secure Connect from the link DishNet sent you (Windows will ask for administrator permission once — this is needed to set up the secure connection).
2. If the app asks for an activation code, type the code DishNet gave you. Codes work once and only on this computer. If you used an install link, this happens by itself.
3. Click **Connect to Office**. Within a few seconds the status shows **Connected**.
4. Follow the checklist on the main screen: it tells you the next step and confirms when your office computer answers.

How to access Tally remotely

1. Make sure the app shows **Connected** and the checklist says the office computer is reachable.
2. Click **Open Remote Desktop**. Windows Remote Desktop opens with the office computer's address filled in.
3. Sign in with the **Windows user name and password of the office computer** (the same ones used at the office). DishNet never asks for, stores or sees this password.
4. The office desktop appears in a window. Open Tally there as you normally do. Tally runs on the office computer; you are seeing and controlling it.
5. Tick the checklist steps once Remote Desktop and Tally work, so DishNet knows your setup is complete.

Tip: if the Remote Desktop window is small, use the full-screen button at the top of that window.

How to disconnect safely

1. In Tally, save your work and close the company as you would at the office.
2. Close the Remote Desktop window (or sign out of Windows inside it).
3. Click **Disconnect** in DishNet Secure Connect.

Disconnecting only closes your private road. The office computer stays on and keeps running for your colleagues.

What to do when the connection fails

Click **Something is not working...** on the main screen. The troubleshooting assistant checks what it can see (activation, the connection, the office computer) and asks you at most three questions to find which of six layers is failing — and who can fix it:

Layer	Who fixes it
1 Activation (code, revoked, trial ended)	DishNet
2 DishNet connection (your internet)	You
3 Office computer (off, offline, Allow not clicked, Windows Home)	The office
4 Remote Desktop (does not open / refused)	You, then the office
5 Windows sign-in (wrong user name or password)	Your office IT contact
6 Tally itself (licence, company file)	Your Tally provider

The most common cases: - **"Connecting..." never becomes "Connected"**: check that your laptop has internet (open any website). The office connection needs the internet on both sides. - **"Reconnecting..."**: your internet dropped. The app reconnects by itself when the internet is back; you do not need to click anything. - **"Office computer not answering"**: the office computer is probably switched off, asleep, or lost its internet. Ask someone at the office to switch it on and check that DishNet shows "Connected" there. Remote Desktop must be allowed on it (the office app asks for this once). - **Remote Desktop opens but sign-in fails**: the user name or password of the office computer is wrong. Use the same ones that work at the office. DishNet cannot reset Windows passwords. - **"Access revoked" or "trial has ended"**: DishNet has stopped this device or your trial finished. Contact DishNet. - **"Problem" with a message**: read the message; most are solved by closing and reopening the app as administrator. If it keeps happening, click **Save diagnostics...** and send the file to DishNet support. The file contains no passwords or keys.

How to add another authorised computer

Each computer needs its own activation. Ask DishNet for a new install link or code for the extra computer. Your business has a limit on the number of computers; DishNet can raise it. Never share one code between two computers — a code works once.

How updates work

DishNet Secure Connect checks for updates once a day. When a new version is available, a yellow bar appears with **Update now**. Click it: the update downloads from DishNet, installs in about a minute, and the app reopens. You do not need to uninstall anything, and your activation stays.

Security, privacy and data location

- Your Tally data stays on your office computer. DishNet does not store, read or copy it.
- The connection is encrypted end to end using WireGuard®, a modern, widely audited protocol.
- Each computer has its own key, created on that computer. The private key never leaves it, not even to DishNet.
- Only computers authorised for **your** business can reach your office computer. Other DishNet customers are completely separate.
- DishNet never asks for your Windows password or Tally password, and the app never records them.
- Diagnostics files you send to support contain technical status only; secrets are removed automatically.

Frequently asked questions

Does the office computer have to be on all the time? Yes, whenever someone needs to work remotely. If it is off or asleep, nobody can connect.

Can two people use Tally remotely at the same time? Remote Desktop on a normal Windows Pro PC allows one person at a time to control the screen. If a colleague is working, you will be asked whether to disconnect them. For several people at once, DishNet must assess Windows Server with Remote Desktop Services, its licensing, and how your Tally is set up — this is a separate assessment, not something the connection alone provides.

Does this work with my version of Tally? DishNet Secure Connect does not change Tally; it shows you the office screen. Whatever works on the office computer works remotely. DishNet confirms this with you during the first test.

My office computer runs Windows Home. Will it work? Windows Home cannot accept Remote Desktop connections. The recommended fix is to upgrade that computer to Windows Pro (a licence upgrade, no reinstall); otherwise use another office computer that runs Pro. DishNet can advise.

Is my internet fast enough? Remote Desktop works well even on modest connections, including Starlink. Large files are not transferred — only the screen.

What does it cost after the trial? Contact DishNet; the app shows how many trial days remain.

How do I get help? Use **Contact DishNet support** in the app.

